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LARGE Fantasy City Expansion: Violets Stone
large (Fate's Edge v1.0)

A plugandplay urban module for Fate's Edge campaigns set among bridges, aqueducts,
rites, caravans, and crown politics.

DESIGN GOALS

City as character. Districts and institutions carry tags, Strings, and timers that push back. **Plug into core.** Use Position/DV, SB, and timers; no new dice math. **Street to state.** Blend casework, capers, and civic settlements. **Low bookkeeping.** Track names and tags; let timers and Strings carry weight.

QUICKSTART (2 MINUTES)

Pick a City Kit (§7). Set Mandate 2 / Crisis 2 unless fiction says otherwise. Choose 4 Factions from the kit; copy their Strings; start each faction's Influence or Agenda timer at 0. Mark 2 volatile stakes on the relationship map (e.g., "Harbor Master owes Corsairs a favor"). Draw the Urban Deck (§6.2): one Incident (Spade), one Person (Heart), one Complication (Club) to spark the opening dilemma. Frame the first Situation Timer [48] and at least one CounterTimer [46]. Play scenes. All 1s generate SB; spend cityflavored Social SB (optional, see §3.4).

Pro Tip: Start with the ThreeTimer Rule – only track the Situation Timer, one CounterClock, and one Campaign Timer at a time.

1) CITY SHEET (TEMPLATE)

[CITY NAME]

Mandate (06): public legitimacy of the company in this city

Crisis (06): ambient pressure (riots, audits, plague, war drums)

Districts (58): each with tags a District Effect (see §2)

Institutions (36): councils, courts, guilds, rites; each has Strings

Factions (48): playset; use Influence / Stability / Exposure timers (see §7)

Relationship Map: arrows with stakes; mark two volatile

Rites Laws: 12 citywide oaths, bans, or permissions that change Position

Chase Modes: foot, canal, rooftops, alleyways (see §5)

Events: festival/omen/weather tables (see §6.3)

District Effect (per scene)

Acting with a district's tags → Position +1 or DV –1 once/scene. Acting against a district's tags → Position –1 or GM banks +1 SB. Whenever a player rolls a 1 in a district, the GM may tick that district's Complication timer (if any) by 1.

large2) DISTRICT TAGS EFFECTS (CHOOSE 68 COMMON)

tem **Harbor Quays** – brackish, fog, bribes, cranes
Effect: +1 Position for Smuggle/Survey; -1 Position for Sanctify/Expose.
Complication timer: *Docksider Rumors* [4]. tem **Market Ward** – hucksters, scales, guild seals
Effect: DV -1 for Broker/Petition with writs; +1 SB on Infiltrate (watchful).
Complication timer: *Guild Audit* [6]. tem **Temple Quarter** – bells, incense, oaths
Effect: Shield/Host Rite start Dominant; Bribe starts Desperate.
Complication timer: *Heresy Inquiry* [6]. tem **Scholars' Quarter** – scriptoriums, apprentices, disputes
Effect: Research/Expose DV -1 with proof; Blackmail Position -1 (they lawyer up).
Complication timer: *Scholastic Feud* [4]. tem **Underways Sewers** – echo, mildew, sigils, smugglers
Effect: Infiltrate DV -1; on any 1, start *Sewer Folk* [4] or *Wards Stir* [6] timer.
Complication timer: *Flood Surge* [6]. tem **Legion/Watch Barracks** – drill, pennons, billets
Effect: Petition (order) starts Dominant; Expose starts Desperate.
Complication timer: *Curfew* [6]. tem **Bridges Canals** – mossy stone, toll bells
Effect: Chase (boat/rooftop) DV -1; Broker worsens if tolls unpaid.
Complication timer: *BridgeLord's Grievance* [4]. tem **Patrician Heights** – courtyards, old blood
Effect: Petition DV -1 with Standing; otherwise Blackmail gains +1 SB.
Complication timer: *Duel Escalation* [4]. tem **Foundries Yards** – smoke, sparks, strikes
Effect: Intimidate/Strikebust Position +1; Host Feast Position -1.
Complication timer: *Rolling Strike* [6]. tem **Bazaars Caravanserais** – spices, dialects, caravan law
Effect: Broker (trade) DV -1; Expose Position -1 (outsider loyalties).
Complication timer: *Caravan Feud* [4].

large3) CITY PROCEDURES

3.1 Scene Framing

State the question; pick a Situation Timer ; set Position DV from fiction + district effect; start a CounterTimer if opposition is active; tag the venue (Audience/Institution).

3.2 Strings (Urban)

Common Strings: Bridge Tolls, Aqueduct Permits, Ferry Passbooks, OathTablet Registry, Harbor Pilots, Festival Licenses, Censor’s Seal, Ship Papers, Privateer Charters, Contraband Manifests.

Acting with/through a relevant String: Position +1 or DV −1 once/scene. To cut or seize a String, start a 4–6 segment timer. On completion, you may:

tem **Seize**: Gain control of the String for your own use. tem **Destroy**: Prevent anyone from using it. tem **Redirect**: Change who controls it (e.g., assign to a different faction).

Example: Cutting the String *Harbor Warrants* [4] – on success, you either obtain legitimate papers or prevent the harbor from issuing warrants against you.

3.3 City Dials (Mandate Crisis)

tem **Mandate (0–6)** – public legitimacy. At 4–5, cancel one Social SB in public venues once/session; public offices DV −1. At 6, start public scenes Dominant unless fiction forbids. tem **Crisis (0–6)** – ambient pressure. At 4–5, first failed public scene ticks party Exposure +1; at 6, start with a crowd CounterTimer [4].

At the end of each session, if total SB spent by the GM exceeds 10, increase Crisis by 1. If the party successfully resolved 2+ major timers, increase Mandate by 1.

3.4 Social SB Menu (optional, cityflavored)

Instead of the generic SB menu (noise, alarm, etc.), GMs may choose from these urban complications:

tem Faux pas title/ritual	tem Lose Cargo inspection	tem Guild audit	tem
1 Favor in venue	tem Leverage leak	Noble scandal	tem Temple censure
→ Exposure +1	tem Crowd turns	Watch curfew	tem Harbor closure
(Warm→Skeptical→Hostile)	tem Permit	Price fixing	tem Counterfeit goods
pulled (lose String access)	tem Patrol arrives	Debt collector	tem Bounty hunter
biased	tem Festival crush	tem Informer betrayal	tem Rival sabotage
tem Toll chain drops	tem Ship quarantine	tem	

3.5 Investigation Timer Management

For longterm mysteries, use an **Investigation Timer** [6]. Each significant clue advances the timer by:

tem Clue Grade D or C → +1 tem Clue Grade B or A → +2 tem Clue Grade A+ → +3

When the timer fills, the GM describes the complete truth – but also introduces a new complication (e.g., the culprit escapes, evidence is destroyed, or a powerful figure is implicated).

Example progression: Clue D (1) → Clue C (1) → Clue B (2) → Clue A+ (3) = 7 segments → truth revealed, but the villain has already fled.

3.6 Between-Session Cycle

Update world state → draw events (§6.3) → resolve off-screen orders → recompute Mandate/Crisis → prep next Situation.

large4) URBAN ACTIONS (ADDITIONS)

tem **Invoke Rite (Wits/Presence + Rite)**: Claim hospitality, sanctuary, or festival privilege. Hit: protective tag; miss: Exposure +1. tem **Grease Palms (Wits + Streetwise)**: Secure permits/tolls. Hit: tag *Greased Palms*; miss: rumor of bribery (Exposure +1). tem **Audit Ledger (Wits + Investigation)**: Catch graft/tithe anomalies. Hit: DV –1 on later Expose. tem **Call the Watch (Presence + Command)**: Leverage order. Hit: *Watchful Patrols* tag; miss: they arrive biased. tem **Smuggle (Wits + Subterfuge)**: Move goods/people across wards. Hit: gain Leverage (1) or fill; 1s start *Contraband Trail* timer. tem **Carouse for Rumors (Presence + Performance)**: Trade coin and stories. Hit: bank 1 Clue (see §6.1); miss: SB → Hangover Debts. tem **Forge Documents (Wits + Tinker)**: Create false papers/permits. Hit: tag *Forged Papers*; miss: Exposure +1. tem **Navigate Politics (Presence + Command)**: Maneuver through civic structures. Hit: DV –1 on next Petition; miss: political rival gains Influence. tem **Bribe Official (Wits + Sway)**: Pay for favors/permissions. Hit: tag *Bribe Accepted*; miss: Exposure +1. tem **Commission Contract (Presence + Broker)**: Hire services/mercenaries. Hit: tag *Contract Secured*; miss: Exposure +1.

large5) CHASES IN TIGHT STREETS (DV LADDERS)

Pick a mode; on a hit, advance Pursuit (or Escape) timer by Effect (1–3).

rule Mode	DV 2	DV 3	DV 4	DV 5
rule Foot	market	alleys	rooftops	through procession
Boat/Canal	open run	under bridges	against tide	fog storm
Mount/Cart	quay road	wagon traffic	stairstreets	temple steps
ShiptoShip	calm waters	choppy seas	storm winds	naval battle
tomrule				

Complications (on 1s): overturned barrow, toll chain drops, lantern goes out, festival throng, rigging tangles, hull breach, powder keg, enemy boarding party, reef strike, sudden fog, cargo shift, crew mutiny.

6) URBAN GENERATORS

6.1 Clues Casework

Grades: A+ (witnessed oath; sealed writ) A (signed testimony; verified mark) B (two source rumor; ledger trail) C (hearsay; graffiti) D (single rumor) F (planted tale; forged writ)

A day without followup degrades one step if contested. Spend: 1 Clue → DV -1 on a related Expose/Petition once.

6.2 Urban Deck (52card)

Draw one card for each of Spade (Incident), Heart (Person), Club (Complication), Diamond (Boons/Resolution). **Timer size** by highest rank: 2-5 → [4], 6-10 → [6], J/Q/K → [8], A → [10].

section*Spades – Incidents ritual misfire • theft of a writ • bridge collapse • missing tax barge • assassin in procession • cursed play • guild strike • seditious broadsheet • shrine desecration • plague rumor • treason trial • flood omen • **Ace:** cover for a coup.

section*Hearts – Persons harbormaster • guild factor • inquisitor • bridgelord • mummer • tribune • ferry pilot • matron • archivist • street saint • exile heir • quartermaster • **Ace:** a most trusted patron is complicit.

section*Clubs – Complications curfew • festival crush • foreign immunities • taboo ground • closed shop • informant vanishes • watch obstruction • blackmail • riot brewing • double agent • cursed weather • **Ace:** solving it ruins someone you love.

section*Diamonds – Boons/Resolution sealed archive • tariff exemption • festival license • street mandate • protection writ • house favor • council seat • tithe forgiving • pardon • endowment • patrol command • treasury award • **Ace:** The Truth, at public cost.

6.3 Events, Omens, Weather

Festivals:

tem Boat Blessing tem
New Charter Day tem
Founders' Procession tem
Lantern Vigil tem Moon
Market tem Salt Bless-
ing tem Ship Launch
tem Merchant's Fair tem
Sailor's Wake tem Gover-
nor's Ball tem Execution
Day tem Tax Collection

Omens:

tem blood tide tem comet
tem cracked idol tem
whisperplague tem au-
gur's scandal tem ship's
bell tolling tem raven's
call tem broken mast tem
cursed cargo tem ghost
ship sighted tem tem-
ple weeping tem market
crash

Weather:

tem fog bank tem heat
wave tem black rain tem
river in spate tem win-
ter of knives tem sud-
den storm tem red sky
tem calm seas tem water-
spout tem ice floes tem
sandstorm tem hurricane
winds

7) CITY KITS (PLAYSETS)

Each kit includes 4 factions with their Aim, Strings, and starting timers. Faction timers (e.g., *Influence* [6]) tick when they achieve their Aim; when full, they make a major move.

7.1 Mid Ahkaz – Ykrul Trade Capital

Districts: Violet Bazaar; Steppe Gate; Satrap Gardens; CoinWeigh House; UnderArcades; Caravan Rings. **Special Rule:** In Bazaars/Caravan Rings, Broker DV −1. Exposing fraud without a CoinWeigh Seal starts Exposure +1.

rule Faction	Aim	Strings
rule CoinWeigh Tribunal (Tier crown)	Stabilize tariffs	Tariff Seals, Coin Scales, Audit Teams
Oasis Clans Compact (Tier city)	Protect wells	Water Shares, Caravan Well Rights, Desert Guides
Foreign Factors' League (Tier guild)	Preferential duties	Warehousing, Bonded Guards, Letters of Credit
SandRoad Brotherhood (Tier street→guild)	Own the underar- cades	Contraband Vaults, Night Porters, False Seals
tomrule		

Adventure Starters: Missing Water Share deeds flood the market • Steppe Rangers feud spills into the Violet Bazaar • A cursed dye caravan seeks sanctuary under the Satrap Gardens.

7.2 Ecktoria – Marble Fire

Districts: Grand Forum; Aqueduct Heights; Legion Quarter; Foundries; Riverside Tenements; Consecrated Courts. **Special Rule:** Any Expose of water theft is public: on hit, Mandate +1; on miss, Exposure +1 (panic).

rule Faction	Aim	Strings
rule Exarchate (Tier crown)	Rebalance old grants	Audit Writs, Tax Ledgers, Censures
Legions Remnant (Tier city)	Restore stipends	Veteran Rolls, Ar- mory Keys, Drill Grounds
Merchant Courts (Tier guild)	Secure monopolies	Guild Charters, Bridge Tolls, Import Licenses
SunTemple Synod (Tier synod)	Purify rites	Sanctuary, Proces- sion Routes, Oath Tablets

tomrule

Adventure Starters: A lost aqueduct patent resurfaces • Legions demand arrears from the treasury • A relic procession goes offscript into riot.

7.3 Silkstrand – City of Bridges

Districts: Bridges Canals; Dye Yards; Archivolt; Playhouse Row; Pilots' Quays; Sestiere Courts. **Special Rule:** In fog, Chase (boat/rooftop) DV -1 but Expose Position -1; a hit satire can create Audience tags citywide.

rule Faction		Aim		Strings
rule Dye Syndi-		Maintain	pigment	Vat Houses, Guild
cate (Tier guild)		monopoly		Scales, Apprentice
				Oaths
BridgeLords (Tier		Rule crossings		Toll Chains, Bridge
city)				Charters, Night Keys
Riverine Patrol		Curb smuggling		Patrol Boats, Fog
(Tier city)				Bells, Harbor War-
				rants
Playhouse Mum-		Public favor		Masque Licenses,
mers (Tier				Satire Broadsheets,
street→guild)				Crowd Hooks
tomrule				

Adventure Starters: A satire names names • The Night Keys list leaks • A foreign pigment line undercuts the vats.

7.4 Thepyrgos – Synod Collegium

Districts: Synod Hill; Collegium of Keys; Harbor Quarter; Law Courts; Pilgrims' Steps; Scriptorium Lanes. **Special Rule:** Begin with rites: Broker starts Dominant; breaking rites adds Exposure +1.

rule Faction		Aim		Strings
rule Archons'		Codify chapterhouse		Writs of Law, Cen-
Synod (Tier		votes		sure, Clerks
crown)				
Collegium (Tier		Protect privileges		Oath Registry,
synod)				Sealed Stacks, Licen-
				tiae
Harbor Guild		Tariffs/pilots		Pilot Licenses, Quay
(Tier guild)				Masters, Lantern-
				Law
EmberTemple		Zeal/charity		Processions, Sanctu-
(Tier synod)				ary, Inquisitors
tomrule				

Adventure Starters: Charter revision threatens the Collegium • Temple schism spills into streets • A curse knits into tithe ledgers.

7.5 Zakov – Iron Haven (Freeport)

Lore: Zakov sits at the mouth of the Iron River, a lawless port ruled by the “Code of the Iron Trident.” Ship captains hold sovereign authority over their vessels. The city is divided into Holds claimed by corsair fleets, merchant houses, and criminal syndicates. The Harbor Master’s Court maintains navigation and collects the “Iron Tithe.”

Districts: Ironworks; Salt Quarter; Smugglers’ Cut; Old Citadel; Copper Market; Blackwater Quays. **Special Rule:** Ships flying no nation’s colors are neutral. Smuggle starts Dominant; Expose a pirate’s identity starts Desperate.

rule Faction	Aim	Strings
rule Ironmasters (Tier guild)	Secure raw ore/export tithes	Foundry Licenses, Ore Contracts, Bonded Guards
Corsair Re- public (Tier street→guild)	Maintain maritime law/territory	Ship Papers, Privateer Charters, Harbor Rights
Harbor Master’s Court (Tier city)	Keep harbor navigable/profitable	Navigation Marks, Docking Rights, Iron Tithe
Salt Guild (Tier guild)	Control salt trade/preservation	Salt Licenses, Preservation Contracts, Trade Routes

tomrule

Adventure Starters: A rival fleet’s flagship appears with no crew • The Iron Tithe ledgers show impossible debts • A ghost ship is sinking legitimate vessels • The Harbor Master’s Court declares martial law.

large8) PLAYERFACING OPTIONS (LIGHT)

Urban Talents: Streetwise, LedgerEye, BridgeRunner, RiteSpeaker, PatrolFriend, CrowdReader, Shipwright, Corsair, Harbor Pilot, SaltTrader.

Background Hooks: Guildtaught, Pilot’s Kin, Temple Page, Festival Barker, Caravan Clerk, Exarchate Apprentice, Ship’s Boy, Corsair Captain, Harbor Guard, Salt Miner, River Runner, Dock Master.

Temptations (optional): Replace vice with Ambition / Comfort / Fury / Pride. Track a 4segment Temptation Timer that the GM can press in districts tagged with that flavor; spend Boons to resist or clear.

large9) GM TOOLKIT

5Minute City Prep

tem Pick 1 City Kit tem Circle 4 Factions tem Highlight 2 Districts for the scene tem Note the Special Rule tem Draw 1 Urban Deck card tem Ready for first scene

Default Ripples (Success / Failure)

tem **Success:** ally Influence +1 (or +2 if on Aim); enemy Exposure +1; clean win reduces ally Exposure -1. tem **Failure:** enemy Influence +1 (or +2 on Aim); ally Exposure +1; internal failure also Stability +1.

DV Cheatsheet

tem Petition: 2-4 (temple/court) tem Broker: 3-4 (neutral ground helps) tem Expose: 3-5 (proof lowers) tem Infiltrate: 3-5 (wards raise)

ThreeTimer Rule

Only maintain three active timers at once: 1. Situation Timer (the current scene's main tension) 2. CounterTimer (opposition or environment) 3. Campaign Timer (faction agenda or longterm threat) Merge or retire others.

large10) PRINTABLE AIDS

tem City Sheet (template) tem District Cards (tags/effects) tem Factions Strings minis tem Urban Deck prompts (52card list) tem Chase Ladders sidecard tem Events Omens minitable tem Investigation Tracker tem Relationship Map Template

largeCHANGELOG

v1.0 – Final revision aligned with core Fate's Edge rules. Streamlined district effects; added district complication timers. Standardized faction timers (Influence/Agenda [6]). Merged String Cutting into core Assets/Timers. Added explicit Investigation Timer progression. Reformatted lists as tables for readability. Expanded Zakov lore and special rules. Reinforced ThreeTimer Rule and 5Minute Prep.

End of v1.0